

002. Chapter 2 Verses 1-10

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.1

सञ्जय उवाच ।
तं तथा कृपयाविष्टमश्रुपूर्णकुलेक्षणम् ।
विषीदन्तमिदं वाक्यमुवाच मधुसूदनः ॥ १ ॥

sañjaya uvāca |
taṁ tathā kṛpayāviṣṭam
aśrupūrṇākulekṣaṇam |
viṣīdantamidaṁ vākyaṁ
uvāca madhusūdanaḥ ||

◆ sañjayaḥ uvāca – Sanjaya said; ◆ tam – to him (Arjuna); tathā – thus; kṛpayā-
āviṣṭam – overwhelmed with pity; ◆ aśru-pūrṇa-ākula-īkṣaṇam – whose eyes
were full of tears and distressed; ◆ viṣīdantam – sorrowing; idam – these;
vākyaṁ – words; ◆ uvāca – spoke; madhusūdanaḥ – Madhusudana (Krishna).

**In this manner, when Arjuna was plunged in a state of
despondency, with eyes blurred with tears, Lord Krishna
addressed these words to him.**

VERSE 2.2

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
कुतस्त्वा कश्मलमिदं विषमे समुपस्थितम् ।
अनार्यजुष्टमस्वर्ग्यमकीर्तिकरमर्जुन ॥ २ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
kutastvā kaśmalamidam
viṣame samupasthitam |
anāryajuṣṭamasvargyam
akīrtikaramarjuna ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ kutaḥ – whence; tvā – to you; kaśmalam – dejection/faint-heartedness; idam – this; ◆ viṣame – in this hour of peril; samupasthitam – come; ◆ anārya-juṣṭam – unbecoming of an Arya (noble person); asvargyam – leading not to heaven; ◆ akīrti-karam – causing disgrace; arjuna – O Arjuna.

The Lord said: O Arjuna! Whence, in this critical situation, has this mental dejection takes hold of you, shameful and Heaven-excluding?

VERSE 2.3

क्लैब्यं मा स्म गमः पार्थ नैतत्त्वय्युपपद्यते ।
क्षुद्रं हृदयदौर्बल्यं त्यक्त्वोत्तिष्ठ परन्तप ॥ ३ ॥

klaibyaṃ mā sma gamaḥ pārtha
naitattvayyupapadyate |
kṣudraṃ hṛdayadaurbalyaṃ
tyaktvottiṣṭha parantapa ||

◆ klaibyam – unmanliness/impotence; mā sma gamaḥ – do not yield to; pārtha – O Partha; ◆ na – not; etat – this; tvayi – in you; upapadyate – is fitting; ◆ kṣudram – petty; hṛdaya-daurbalyam – weakness of heart; ◆ tyaktvā – abandoning; uttiṣṭha – arise; parantapa – O scorcher of foes.

**O Arjuna! Do not yield to impotence. It does not befit you.
Cast off this wretched weakness of heart. Arise, O scorcher of
enemies!**

VERSE 2.4

अर्जुन उवाच ।

कथं भीष्ममहं सङ्ख्ये द्रोणं च मधुसूदन ।

इषुभिः प्रतियोत्स्यामि पूजार्हावरिसूदन ॥ ४ ॥

arjuna uvāca |

katham bhīṣmamahaṁ saṅkhye

droṇaṁ ca madhusūdana |

iṣubhiḥ pratiyotsyāmi

pūjārḥavarisūdana ||

◆ arjunaḥ uvāca – Arjuna said; ◆ katham – how; bhīṣmam – Bhishma; aham – I; saṅkhye – in battle; ◆ droṇam – Drona; ca – and; madhusūdana – O Madhusudana; ◆ iṣubhiḥ – with arrows; pratiyotsyāmi – shall fight against; ◆ pūjā-arḥau – worthy of worship; ari-sūdana – O destroyer of enemies.

Arjuna Said: O Krishna! Bhishma and Drona are my teachers fit to be worshipped. How can I attack them with arrows in the battle?

VERSE 2.5

गुरुनहत्वा हि महानुभावान्
श्रेयो भोक्तुं भैक्ष्यमपीह लोके ।
हत्वार्थकामांस्तु गुरुनिहैव
भुञ्जीय भोगान् रुधिरप्रदिग्धान् ॥ ५ ॥

gurūnahatvā hi mahānubhāvān
śreya bhoktum bhaikṣyamapīha loke |
hatvārthakāmāṃstu gurūnihaiva
bhuñjīya bhogān rudhirapradigdhān ||

◆ gurūn – elders/teachers; ahatvā – not killing; hi – indeed; mahā-anubhāvān – most noble; ◆ śreyaḥ – better; bhoktum – to eat; bhaikṣyam – food obtained by begging; api – even; iha loke – in this world; ◆ hatvā – killing; artha-kāmān – desiring wealth and gain; tu – but; gurūn – teachers; iha – here; eva – only; ◆ bhuñjīya – I would enjoy; bhogān – enjoyments; rudhira-pradigdhān – stained with blood.

It would be better, indeed, to live on alms in this world rather than to slay these high-souled teachers. But if I kill them, even here I shall enjoy wealth and desires stained with their blood.

VERSE 2.6

न चैतद्विद्मः कतरन्नो गरीयो
यद्वा जयेम यदि वा नो जयेयुः ।
यानेव हत्वा न जिजीविषाम
स्तेऽवस्थिताः प्रमुखे धार्तराष्ट्राः ॥ ६ ॥

na caitadvidmaḥ kataranno garīyo
yadvā jayema yadi vā no jayeyuḥ |
yāneva hatvā na jijīviṣāmas
te'vasthitāḥ pramukhe dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ ||

◆ na – not; ca – and; etat – this; vidmaḥ – we know; katarat – which; naḥ – for us; garīyaḥ – better; ◆ yat vā – whether; jayema – we should conquer; yadi vā – or if; naḥ – us; jayeyuḥ – they should conquer; ◆ yān – whom; eva – even; hatvā – having killed; na – not; jijīviṣāmaḥ – we wish to live; ◆ te – they; avasthitāḥ – are standing; pramukhe – in front; dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ – the sons of Dhritarashtra.

We do not know which would be the better for us: that we should conquer them or they should conquer us. Arrayed against us stand the very sons of Dhritarāshtra, after slaying whom we should not wish to live.

VERSE 2.7

कार्पण्यदोषोपहतस्वभावः
पृच्छामि त्वां धर्मसम्मूढचेताः ।
यच्छ्रेयः स्यान्निश्चितं ब्रूहि तन्मे
शिष्यस्तेऽहं शाधि मां त्वां प्रपन्नम् ॥ ७ ॥

kārpaṇyadoṣopahatasvabhāvaḥ
pṛcchāmi tvāṃ dharmasammūḍhacetash |
yacchreyaḥ syānniścitaṃ brūhi tanme
śiṣyaste'haṃ śādhi mām tvāṃ prapannam ||

◆ kārpaṇya-doṣa – the taint of pity/weakness; upahata – overcome; svabhāvaḥ – nature; ◆ pṛcchāmi – I ask; tvāṃ – You; dharma-sammūḍha-cetāḥ – with a mind confused about duty; ◆ yat – what; śreyaḥ – the highest good; syāt – may be; niścitaṃ – decisively; brūhi – tell; tat – that; me – to me; ◆ śiṣyaḥ – disciple; te – Your; aham – I am; śādhi – instruct; mām – me; tvāṃ – in You; prapannam – surrendered.

(O Krishna!) My mind is distracted by the taint of pity and I am ignorant of what my duty is, and so, I ask you to teach me what is good for me. I am your disciple. I take refuge in you.

VERSE 2.8

न हि प्रपश्यामि ममापनुद्याद्
यच्छोकमुच्छोषणमिन्द्रियाणाम् ।
अवाप्य भूमावसपत्नमृद्धं
राज्यं सुराणामपि चाधिपत्यम् ॥ ८ ॥

na hi prapaśyāmi mamāpanudyād
yaccho kamucchoṣaṇamindriyāṇām |
avāpya bhūmāvasapatnamṛddham
rājyaṁ surāṇāmapi cādhipatyam ||

◆ na – not; hi – indeed; prapaśyāmi – I see; mama – my; apanudyāt – would dispel; ◆ yat – which; śokam – grief; ucchoṣaṇam – drying up; indriyāṇām – the senses; ◆ avāpya – having obtained; bhūmau – on earth; asapatnam – unrivaled; ṛddham – prosperous; ◆ rājyam – kingdom; surāṇām – of the gods; api – even; ca – and; ādhipatyam – lordship.

I can find no means to drive away this grief which is drying up my senses. I will not be able to dispel it even if I win a prosperous, unrivaled kingdom on earth with sovereignty like the demigods in heaven.

VERSE 2.9

सञ्जय उवाच ।

एवमुक्त्वा हृषीकेशं गुडाकेशः परन्तप ।

न योत्स्य इति गोविन्दमुक्त्वा तूष्णीं बभूव ह ॥९॥

sañjaya uvāca |

evamuktvā hr̥ṣīkeśam

guḍākeśaḥ parantapa |

na yotsya iti govindam

uktvā tūṣṇīm babhūva ha ||

◆ sañjayaḥ uvāca – Sanjaya said; ◆ evam – thus; uktvā – having spoken; hr̥ṣīkeśam – to Hrishikesha (Krishna); ◆ guḍākeśaḥ – Gudakesha (Arjuna); parantapa – the scorcher of foes; ◆ na yotsye – I will not fight; iti – thus; govindam – to Govinda; ◆ uktvā – having said; tūṣṇīm – silent; babhūva – became; ha – indeed.

Sanjaya Said: Having spoke thus, Arjuna, the destroyer of foes, finally said to Lord Krishna, “I will not fight” and became silent.

VERSE 2.10

तमुवाच हृषीकेशः प्रहसन्निव भारत ।
सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये विषीदन्तमिदं वचः ॥ 10 ॥

tamuvāca hr̥ṣīkeśaḥ
prahasanniva bhārata |
senayorubhayormadhye
viṣīdantamidaṃ vacaḥ ||

◆ tam – to him; uvāca – spoke; hr̥ṣīkeśaḥ – Hrishikesha; ◆ prahasan – smiling; iva – as if; bhārata – O Bharata (Dhritarashtra); ◆ senayoḥ ubhayoḥ madhye – in the midst of the two armies; ◆ viṣīdantam – to the sorrowing one; idam – these; vacaḥ – words.

O king Dhritarashtra! Seeing Arjuna lamenting in the middle of two armies, Lord Krishna, as if laughing loud, spoke these words.